



A PODCAST FOR LYND A

The Best is Yet to Come

The simplest way, in 2026, to record real conversations with people you'd like to interview — and have them appear as a published podcast. A plain-language overview, so we can talk it through together.

Prepared for Dr. Lynda Klau

A conversation starter

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WHAT THIS IS

A friendly overview — read before we talk

You've imagined a show — *The Best is Yet to Come* — where you have a conversation with someone and record it. This isn't a technical manual. It's a short walk through **how simple starting a podcast has actually become**, so nothing about the "how" stands between you and the conversations.

What you want

To interview people — remotely — and have each episode appear on Spotify and Apple Podcasts.

What you don't want

To juggle software, wrestle audio files, or learn a stack of technical tools just to press record.

The promise

One tool, a few clicks per episode — and the one-time setup done just once, right at the start.

THE WAY IT USUALLY WORKS

Normally, a podcast means assembling a small stack of tools

This is what has scared people off for years — not the talking, but everything around it. A typical setup asks a beginner to learn and connect **six to eight separate tools**:

Scheduling

A separate booking tool for guests

Recording

A remote studio like Zoom or Zencastr

Editing

Audio software (Audacity, Descript)

Hosting

A podcast host (Buzzsprout, Captivate)

Uploads

Export the file, re-upload each episode

Submission

List the show on Apple & Spotify

Show notes

Write a summary for every episode

Website + clips

A site, plus social snippets

None of it is about the conversation. All of it is why most people never start.

In 2026, it collapses to two things

We looked into the current options to find the **simplest, least-technical** path for you. As of mid-2026, here's where it landed — the whole stack folds into two things:

1 • Riverside.fm

↗ riverside.com

One **platform** where you **record** with remote guests, let it **clean up** the audio, and **publish** — all in the same place. It even **hosts** the show for you, so there's no separate host and no files to move.

RECORD → EDIT → HOST → PUBLISH

2 • Spotify for Creators

↗ creators.spotify.com

A **free** service from Spotify that carries your show out to the listening apps. Set up *once*, then it just works in the background.

DISTRIBUTES EVERYWHERE • FREE

Everything on the previous slide folds into these two. You live in **one** tool. The rest is handled — most of it just once, at the start.

Five steps — and none of them touch a file

- 1** **Open your studio.** Your reusable recording room in Riverside — the same one every time, set up once.
- 2** **Invite your guest.** Add their email and Riverside sends the link — or copy the studio link and send it yourself.
- 3** **Press record.** Have your conversation. When you're done, press stop.
- 4** **Review & title it.** Riverside tidies the audio and drafts notes; you review and pick a title.
- 5** **Publish.** One button. The episode goes live on Spotify, Apple, and YouTube.

Riverside is the one tool to get comfortable with — it's yours to drive. Good to know: your *studio* is one reusable room you set up once, and a recording *becomes* an episode when you publish it — there's no separate "episode" to create first. It's built to be learned quickly (tutorials at the end).

YOUR GUESTS JUST CLICK A LINK

The remote-guest part is genuinely easy

Nothing to install

Your guest opens the link in their browser (Chrome or Edge work best) and they're in. No app, no account, no setup call beforehand.

Everyone sounds good

Each person is recorded in high quality on their own device — so even a shaky internet connection doesn't ruin the audio.

Room for a group

You and up to nine guests at once — plenty for a one-on-one interview or a small panel.

This is the part people worry about most — "will my guest be able to figure it out?" With a single link, they will.

AFTER YOU PRESS STOP

The tedious production work is drafted for you

You drive the recording; then Riverside automatically prepares the "produced" version of your episode. You stay in control — everything it makes is a **draft you review and approve**.

Cleaner audio

Background noise reduced, levels smoothed.

Show notes & title

A written summary and a title suggestion.

Chapters

Timestamps for the topics you covered.

Transcript

A full written version of the conversation.

Short clips

Highlight moments cut for social media.

Text-based trims

Delete a stumble by deleting the words.

Everything here is a draft you can accept as-is or lightly adjust — never a technical chore.

WHERE YOUR EPISODES APPEAR

On the listening apps — and on your own website

The podcast apps

When you publish an episode, one **Publish** sends it to **Spotify** and **Apple** as audio and to **YouTube** as video. The technical "feed" that carries the audio to the apps is handled for you — you never see it.

Your own website

Want episodes on *drlyndaklau.com* too? A small **Spotify player** drops right into your site — visitors press play there. An easy job for whoever helps with your website.

The show lives everywhere your listeners already are — and on your own site as a natural extension of *Life Unlimited*.

One setup at the very start — then never again

Everything so far is the everyday rhythm. There's also a **single setup at the very beginning**: creating your accounts and listing the show on Apple & Spotify. It happens **once** — and it's much simpler now, because at first only two platforms are involved (plus the free Apple & Spotify listings).

Accounts you'd make anyway

Sign up for Riverside (your subscription, your card) and the free Spotify for Creators. Ordinary sign-ups, done once.

Often easiest by you

These use your email and two-factor codes sent to your phone — so it's often simplest to do yourself. A VA or your web person can also help.

Then automatic

Once the show is listed on Apple & Spotify, every episode you publish flows out to them automatically — you never repeat the listing step.

There are plenty of tutorials that walk through this one-time listing, step by step.

THE ONE PIECE OF GEAR

A simple desk mic — and you're set

You don't need a studio. **One good USB microphone** sits on your desk and plugs in with a single cable. Because it has a headphone jack built in, you plug your **wired earbuds or headphones straight into the mic** — so recording *and* listening are handled by one device. Nothing to configure.

- ✓ Plug-and-play USB-C — no audio interface, no software
- ✓ Built-in headphone jack — one-cable live monitoring
- ✓ Mute button + gain dial right on the mic

Your laptop's mic works in a pinch — but this small, one-time upgrade makes you sound noticeably more present and professional.

OUR ONE RECOMMENDATION

Sennheiser Profile USB

A cardioid condenser mic with a desk stand. Reviewers' beginner favorite — a warm, broadcast-ready voice right out of the box, no tweaking needed.

~\$129 · one-time

[View on Amazon →](#)

USUALLY MANY TOOLS → NOW BUILT IN

The same jobs, quietly handled

THE JOB	THE OLD WAY	NOW
Book & meet the guest	Separate scheduling + video tool	One link, in Riverside
Record everyone in HD	A remote recording studio	Built in
Clean up the audio	Editing software to learn	Automatic draft
Store & serve the show	A separate podcast host	Built in (hosting)
Get each episode online	Export a file, re-upload it	One publish button
Write show notes & title	Write by hand every time	Drafted for you
List on Apple & Spotify	Manual submission	One-time, at signup
Episodes on your website	Build a player yourself	Paste-in Spotify player

WHAT IT COSTS

One modest subscription, plus a free service

Riverside

~\$29 / month

The paid plan that includes hosting, the AI tools, and longer recordings. A bit less if paid yearly.

Spotify for Creators

Free

Hosting and distribution to the apps, at no cost.

The old stack, for contrast

A separate host (\$19–99/mo), editing software (\$16–24/mo), a recording tool, and a website — several bills, several logins.

If you'd want help setting things up or adding the player to your website, that assistance would be an **additional** cost — the figures above are just the software.

Prices as listed July 2026 and can change — the point is the shape: one small subscription instead of many.

WHAT YOU NEVER HAVE TO TOUCH

The list of things that are simply not your problem

✓ Downloading or uploading audio files

✓ Anything called "RSS" or a "feed"

✓ Audio editing software

✓ A separate hosting platform

✓ Manual submissions after episode one

✓ Asking guests to install anything

A FEW HONEST, PRACTICAL NOTES

So there are no surprises

There's a little **getting-started homework**. Set up a Riverside.fm account and watch a tutorial or two. Getting familiar with that one tool is the real prerequisite — and it's designed to be learned quickly.

Hosting comes with the **paid plan**. The all-in-one convenience is why the ~\$29/month plan is the one to use — the free tier can't host your show.

The **Apple listing is one small technical step**. It happens once, at the start — you, a VA, or your web person can take care of it.

Nothing here traps you. If the show grows and you ever want more, everything can be moved to another service later.

LEARN IT IN AN AFTERNOON

A few plain-English walkthroughs (not sales pitches)

Independent teachers who walk you through it gently, screen by screen. Riverside's tools change fast, so these are dated — **favor the freshest**. One or two is genuinely enough to feel ready.

Riverside FM: Complete Beginner Tutorial — Editing, Magic Clips & Hosting →

Emma's Productivity Lab · **May 2026** · record → edit → AI clips → publishing & hosting, all current.

How To Edit A Video Podcast in 2026 (Riverside Beginners) →

Collin Michael · **2026** · a close look at the AI / transcript-based editing.

Riverside University — the maker's own short lessons →

Riverside · **kept current** · recording, the AI tools, and hosting — always up to date.

Gear & getting online

Can I use the Blue mic I already own?

Yes — it's a real podcasting mic. A little less plug-and-play than the Sennheiser, but no reason to buy another. Learn its settings once and you're set.

How does it get on YouTube?

When you publish an episode in Riverside, it sends the audio to Spotify & Apple and the *video* to YouTube (a video is what YouTube wants, and Riverside makes one). Connect your accounts once — then it's one Publish per episode, with no files to upload.

What earbuds or headphones?

Apple wired EarPods (~\$19) are plenty to start; the Sony MDR-7506 (~\$100) are the quintessential podcaster headphones when you upgrade. Never monitor on speakers.

Should it live on my website?

Yes — treat each episode like a blog post (the show notes *are* the post) and embed the Spotify player. Your web person sets the pattern up once.

Frequency, audience & promotion

How often should I publish?

Monthly is sustainable and perfect if you're doing this for the joy. Real audience growth realistically needs weekly — some go daily. Choose the pace you'll enjoy and leave growth for much later.

How do I promote it?

Start with the audience you already have — your list and followers (they'll still need to actively subscribe, so nudge them). For genuinely new listeners, guesting on other people's podcasts is the most reliable lever; a small Facebook-ad budget buys the first few.

Can I target two audiences?

Yes. You only need a narrow niche if growth and monetization are the goal. For a message-and-conversations show, two is fine — even if it slightly blurs "who's this for."

The question under all of these: are you doing this to build and monetize an audience, or because you feel compelled to? Your answer quietly settles most of them.

The craft & your blind spots

Which great interviewers should I study?

It's subjective — study the podcasts *you* already love and ask why: the pacing, the questions, how they listen. One caution: shows that feel effortless (NPR, Hidden Brain) have teams, researchers, and heavy editing behind them, and many aren't even interviews. Don't measure your own monthly show against a machine.

What you're not asking — four things

The guests are the real work — booking, prepping questions, thanking them. The tech is the easy part.

Own your own logins — email + 2FA mean it's best set up by you, even with help.

Set a "good enough, publish it" bar — perfectionism quietly kills new shows.

Think in a small season — commit to six episodes, then reassess. Finite beats "forever."

WHAT THIS IS REALLY FOR

The rewards that actually show up

Worth being clear about what success looks like — and what it doesn't. This isn't about money, monetization, or explosive audience growth. The real rewards are quieter, and better:

A joyful creative practice

Nearly everyone we've seen do this finds the process itself genuinely rewarding.

Deeper relationships

Real, in-depth conversations with the people you interview build lasting connection.

Time with what you love

Hours spent on the topics and questions that matter most to you.

Saved for posterity

These conversations become a lasting body of work — kept, shareable, and yours.

If those are the wins, it's well worth doing.

BEFORE WE TALK

A few things worth sitting with

Nothing to decide yet — just notice what draws you. These are the questions we can explore together.

How often would feel joyful, not a chore? Monthly is perfect for the love of it; more often if you're hoping to grow an audience.

What would make this feel like a success to you?

Which topics and questions are you most drawn to explore?

The best is yet to come.

Sources & References

The facts behind this overview

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